Spop 2018 - Season 1 - Ep1 & 2 rewrite

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Spop 2018 - Season 1 - Ep1 & 2 rewrite

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Summary

The same She-Ra and the Princesses of Power, but if Shadow Weaver were an overprotective "mother" who genuinely wants the best for Adora and Catra (even if she remains her wicked self).

Notes

Hi there! Welcome to the result of a funny little challenge I got thrown last week lol

I actually completed the challenge (aka, rewriting the first 2 episodes of Spop with an overprotective SW instead) in 48hrs BUT I had workers on my room repairing the ceiling so I didn't have access to my PC and couldn't properly sit to edit and post.

The time has come, at last! So, thanks to Solaris, you're about to read two chapters of suspiciously the *same* series but… slightly different!

I'd say, it's all the same events, with some different reasons behind the decisions made. You'll soon understand…

See the end of the work for more notes

The Sword - Part 1

Chapter Notes

Alright, Episode 1 rewrite

I was tempted to leave it in the transcript format BUT I feel like properly writing the whole thing is better, even if it took a bit more time.
Worth it!

I hope you enjoy this first part!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The dark sky shimmers with muted shades of purple and smaller planets orbit the planet Etheria.

Beyond the flowery meadows of Etheria, a city rises out of a patch of scorched earth and an outcropping of jagged rocks.

Raised roadways and ghoulish robotic structures surround the city landscape.

A young woman cinches a belt around her waist and dons a pair of boots.

She pulls her hair back in a ponytail and her armband glows; she boxes a punching bag and brushes her teeth afterwards.

She then salutes the mirror and mimics gunshots.

Right after, leering at a picture of an evil figure on her punching bag, she says —Hey, princess, you looking at me?

With a shout, she kicks the bag right before the voice of a woman talks over the speakers.

—All squadrons, report to training area immediately for evaluation.

It was time for Adora to show what she can do.

Soon after, she takes her place beside three more recruits and asks, in hushed tones —Psst. Anyone seen Catra?— to which her fellow recruit, Lonnie, simply mumbles a negative. With a scoff, she lets out —Not again.

—At attention, cadets— a bulky blue Horde commander calls. —Your simulation is about to begin. Here's your scenario: You'll be passing through the treacherous Whispering Woods to

reach the heart of the rebel insurgency, Bright Moon— he explains, making Kyle whimper. —Your mission is to defeat the Queen of the Princesses and liberate Bright Moon in Lord Hordak's name— he concludes. But then, he realizes —Where's Catra?

—She will be here. I promise— Adora assures him.

—Mm-hmm— he accepts. Then, he goes on —The Whispering Woods is full of princesses. Vicious, violent instigators. They will take you out if given the chance. Don't give it to them. Good luck, recruits.

With that, they head into a training arena and a purple princess immediately appears overhead.

—Watch out!— Adora quickly yells.

—Oh, no, no, no, no, no!— Kyle reacts, scared.

Indistinct shouting begins; the princess fires as the recruits dash into the arena, and Adora hurls an explosive.

—Come on, this way— she orders, and the recruits run while a figure watches from above, growling.

Right after, Kyle is hit and his teammates return to him. His suit is sizzling and an X appears on the plate.

—Aw, dang it!

—Seriously, Kyle?— Adora lets out, reproaching.

—Bra-vo— Lonnie mockingly utters. Kyle frowns but has no time to reply as three princesses hover over them. Over the sound of gunshots, she exclaims —Seriously, Kyle?

But once again, everything is happening too fast and Adora orders —Run!

As the princesses fire, the recruits hold shields over their heads, covering themselves while she sprints ahead instead.

—Adora!— Lonnie calls, right before an alarm starts beeping.

Red hexagons glow red under Adora's feet and a robotic orb shoots up from the floor; it morphs into a four-legged robot and Adora runs at it with a saber.

She pulls herself onto the robot's head and bashes its guns with her saber.

She gasps and yells while another alarm beeps and then smashes the robot, which sinks into the floor.

Adora then leaps off and flops onto the floor face-down.

Right after, Catra strides past her and pushes the crackling robot into the pit on the ground. Adora raises her head and Catra, smiling smugly, points at the red symbol beneath her.

Adora falls in with a yelp, and Catra looks down at her from above, smirking.

—Hey, Adora. How's it hanging?

—Catra. Did you really show up late and let us do all the hard parts? That is low, even for you— she reproaches her.

—Aw. You know nothing's too low for me— she laughs. —Now come on, you look stupid hanging down there.

—Training exercise successfully completed— the voice announces over the speakers.

As the girls return to the lockers, Catra laughs a bit at Adora.

—You should've seen your face. You were like, "Aah, no! Betrayal".

—Come on, Catra— Adora scoffs. —We're senior cadets now. I can't believe you're still pulling such childish, immature- Is that a mouse!?— she suddenly exclaims, pointing behind Catra.

Jumping back, she yelps —What!? Where!?

—Are you ever going to *not* fall for that?— Adora immediately laughs, while Catra's expression shifts, offended.

—I don't know. Are you ever going to *let it go*? That was *one time*.

—I know, but for some reason it's always funny.

—Adora— a deep voice suddenly calls.

Oh, they would know that voice anywhere.

—Shadow Weaver— she replies, turning to look at the dark sorceress as she approaches.

—You have done well— she begins. —You've completed your training course in record time.

—Uh, well, that wasn't just me. You know, Catra did, too— Adora quickly points out, hooking an arm around the magicat.

—Ah, yes— she sighs. —Catra did too, despite arriving *late*. But I have to ask: where exactly were you, Child?

—Around…— the girl replies, looking away and smirking a bit.

—I'll ask again: Where were you, Catra?— she repeats, severe.

—Just around! Nowhere too far that I couldn't hear those morons yelling. What matters is that I arrived on time!

—Do not be flippant with me, cadet— she immediately scolds her, towering over her, menacingly. —You *know* the Fright Zone is a dangerous place. How many times do I have to tell you!? How many times do I have to repeat it!? If you were to get lost, hurt, captured, what do you expect me to do!? I *cannot* do anything if I don't know where you are!

—Sorry, Shadow Weaver— Catra promptly apologizes, looking down.

Calming down, the dark sorceress sighs and, as if nothing had happened, orders —Adora, walk with me.

That sounds serious.

Is she mad?

Hesitant, the girls exchange a glance and Catra shrugs.

—Do you think…

—Adora!— Shadow Weaver interrupts, making her jump slightly and run after her. As they start walking together through the halls, the dark sorceress explains —Lord Hordak has been watching you. He thinks you are a fine candidate for Force Captain.

—Really? Force Captain? Lord Hordak said that about me?

—Oh yes. He sees great promise in you— she confirms. —In fact, he has elected you the honor of leading a squadron in the invasion of the rebel Fortress of Thaymor— she elaborates.

—Thaymor? You mean we're finally seeing active duty?

—Much as I dread it, *you* are seeing active duty.

—But… I'll be able to bring my team along, right?

—Your team is *not* ready— Shadow Weaver sighs. —They'll only slow you down, put you at risk, and likely cause you to *fail*— she enumerates. —Allowing you to go being so young is already an ill-advised decision Lord Hordak made, one I would refute if possible.

—But…

—Adora. How can you expect me to let you go into the battlefield without proper support? I cannot accompany you, I cannot *protect* you— the dark sorceress insists, her tone condescending as she brushes back Adora's hair. —Now put yourself in my place and extend my worry to all your squad.

—Shadow Weaver, with respect, they've been training hard for this, too. And Catra… all she wants is to get out there and prove herself.

—Prove herself? How exactly will she do that if you end up having to drag her corpse back?— the woman asks, as if it were obvious she will *not* succeed. —No, Adora. The only one whom I'm reluctantly allowing to go is *you*— she sighs, producing a brand new Force Captain badge. As the girl takes it, Shadow Weaver expresses —This is what I raised you for, Adora. I saw talent in you the moment I found you as an orphan child and took you in. Is this not what you've wanted since you were old enough to want anything?

—Yes.

—Then you see why, with all the pain in my heart, I'm allowing you to go— she remarks. —With you at the forefront, we will crush the Bright Moon Rebellion once and for all. Do *not* disappoint me— she severely states. —And return in one piece— she concludes, tilting Adora's face to look at her.

As she nods silently, the dark sorceress walks away and she's left gazing out of the window.

Meanwhile, at a white castle perched on a mountain beside a blue lake, the Queen of Bright Moon sits on her throne at the Royal Hall.

—Send her in.

A young woman enters, accompanied by some guards, and approaches her.

Once close enough, she kneels, saying —Your Majesty.

—I'm told you disobeyed orders and led the Rebellion into a dangerous combat situation after you were ordered to retreat.

—I was trying to protect a village from falling into The Horde's grasp— she argues.

—You were reckless and put yourself and the other rebels in danger— the Queen counters, raising her tone.

—Fighting is *supposed* to be dangerous! How are we going to hold our own against The Horde if we keep retreating? Pretty soon, we won't have anything left to defend.

—I'm growing tired of your back-talking, Commander Glimmer— she scolds her.

—Why did you even make me a commander if you won't let me fight?

—That's enough! You're grounded!— the Queen decides.

—*Mom*!— Glimmer scoffs, dropping all decorum in favour of more childish behaviour.

—You heard me!

—You never let me do anything!

—We are not having this discussion tonight. You are embarrassing me in front of my royal court— the Queen complains, earning a few raised brows from the guards, which she fails to notice.

—Oh, *I'm* embarrassing you?— Glimmer mocks her.

Angered, the Queen stands up, opens her wings wide, almost menacingly, and orders —Go to your room!

—I'm *going*!— Glimmer rebukes, furiously storming out.

Frowning, the Queen lets out a sigh and supports her head with one hand, seemingly troubled.

Back in the Fright Zone, perched over a high terrace, Adora gazes over the dark city. She pulls the badge from her pocket and pins it to her jacket.

Right after, Catra leaps on her, making her grunt.

—What'd she say?— she first asks, before seeing the badge and completely shifting her focus as she takes it from her. —Hey, what's this?

—Hey! Give it back.

—No way. You've been *promoted*?— she realizes.

—Well, kind of. I mean, yeah, I guess. Heh— Adora nervously admits. —But it's not a big deal.

—Are you kidding? That is *awesome*— Catra exclaims. —We're gonna see the world and conquer it. Adora, I need to blow something up!— she says, purring a bit, eyes shining.

—Umm.

—What?

—Shadow Weaver says you're not coming— Adora sighs, unable to look her in the eye.

—What? My time was just as good as yours today. What is her problem with me?— Catra asks, indignant. —Is it because of what I told her!?

—Catra… She’s just worried for us. She didn’t want me to be sent to the battlefield either, but it’s a direct order from Lord Hordak— Adora tries to argue. —She said- No, well, I’m not… repeating what she said, but, trust me. She’s looking out for us all.

—That bitter old witch is just punishing me! I know it!

—No, she's not! It's for your own good. You could be a bit more respectful…— Adora then remarks, reproachingly.

—Why should I respect her? She doesn't have *any* real power that doesn't come from Hordak and everyone knows it. I guess it sure must be easy being a people pleaser like you.

—I am not a pe- Catra, wait!— Adora exclaims, sighing as Catra scurries off. With a frown, she chases after her and finally finds her sitting alone on a rooftop. She propels over the side of the structure and joins her. —Look, I'm sorry. I didn't even think you wanted to be a Force Captain.

—I don't— Catra scoffs. —Here, take your stupid badge— she utters, tossing it back to Adora.

—Come on, Catra. This is what I have been working for my entire life— she argues, echoing Shadow Weaver's words. —I was hoping you could be, I don't know, happy for me.

—Ugh, whatever. It's not like I even care— Catra lies. —I just wanna get out of this dump at some point before I die of boredom. I wonder what's even outside the Fright Zone anyway— she adds, genuinely curious.

—Why don't we go find out?— Adora proposes, producing a skiff's ignition key.

—Shadow Weaver will be *mad*.

—We'll deal with her later— she smirks.

—I take it all back! You're officially awesome! I can't believe you actually stole a skiff!— Catra exclaims, as they speed through the wasteland.

—Borrowed! Please don't make me regret this— Adora pleads, already starting to regret it as she maneuvers the skiff.

—I've always wanted to drive one of these things. Here, gimme— she excitedly requests, taking control of the skiff.

—Whoa, there. Save us enough fuel to get back— she promptly warns her.

—That's a problem for future Adora and Catra— the magicat smirks.

—I'm driving!

—I want it!

—Can't have it!

They scream and shout over each other as they fight to control the skiff, and fail to notice the dark forest quickly approaching.

—Let me!

—Give me! I’m doing it!

—Adora, I want it!

—No, *I’ve* got it!

They keep yelling, the forest gets closer and closer, until finally, Adora exclaims —Catra!

The girls barely manage to stop the skiff at the edge of the dark forest…

—What is it?— the magicat asks as they slowly advance with the skiff between the first trees.

—I think this must be the Whispering Woods— Adora replies. —They say there are strange, old monsters in there, an-and the trees move when you're not looking. Every Horde squadron they've sent in there has never come out again.

—Let's go in— Catra decides, excited again.

—Wait, what?— she reacts, immediately yelling as Catra speeds up.

—Woo-hoo!— the magicat shouts, laughing wholeheartedly.

They veer around the winding trunks of towering trees, both screaming as the skiff starts to get out of control.

—Catra, slow down! Catra, tree! Tree!

Grunting, Adora manages to take control and they fly up right before hitting a wide tree. However, a vine catches her neck and she falls backwards.

—Adora!

The girl yells and grunts as she falls, and eventually crashes face-first on the ground.

As she rises, a small glowing orb floats over her, calling her attention.

She swears she hears whispers and immediately calls —Catra? Huh?—, but there’s nothing other than something shining in a clearing. As she approaches, she eventually distinguishes the form of a sword entangled in vines. —Whoa— she breathes, walking towards it. —Cool — she sighs, right before touching the handle, getting blinded by a flashing light.

Adora gasps and a female voice starts speaking in her head out of nowhere.

—Balance must be restored. Etheria must seek a hero.

The girl then hears the crying of a baby, images she can’t understand flash in her mind, and the female voice keeps calling her name.

Until…

—Hey, Adora? Adora!

—Catra? What happened?— she asks, opening her eyes to see the magicat over her.

—You fell out of the skiff after you drove it into a tree.

—No, *you* drove it into a tree— Adora retorts, remembering what had happened.

—Ah, up for debate. Come on, let's go— Catra ushers her.

—Wait. Where is it? Where'd it go?— the girl asks, looking around.

—What?

—Ther-there was a sword. It was *right here*. I tried to touch it, but it got really bright— Adora explains, confused.

—Are you brain-damaged? Don't be brain-damaged— Catra pleads, worried. —Oh, Shadow Weaver's gonna kill me.

—I'm not brain-damaged. It was here, I saw it.

—Well, there's nothing here now. So, come on, let's go— Catra insists, pulling Adora by her ponytail towards the skiff.

And so, the magicat immediately drives out of the forest, while Adora glances back at the empty clearing…

Meanwhile, back at Bright Moon's palace, Glimmer lays in bed writing her diary.

—"Dear Mom, I know you'll never read this, but I have to say it somewhere. I feel like you… don't respect me."— she reads aloud, right as a figure outside aims and shoots an arrow at her window, making her shriek when it hits her bed frame. From the arrow emerges a note adorned with hearts that reads "Look Outside!" and so she groans and looks out of the window. —Watch it! You almost hit me!

Completely oblivious, a young man replies —Hey, Glimmer.

—Shh! Bow, what are you doing here?— she asks, in hushed tones.

—What did you say? Come down here— he requests.

—I can't, I'm grounded— she replies, still whispering.

—What?

—I'm *grounded*.

—…What?— Bow insists, unable to hear her.

—I'm… grounded!— she repeats, teleporting to Bow and bringing him back to her room with her. He yelps, startled, but she only sighs and starts complaining —I'm *so* mad at my mom.

—Is this about the siege on Elberon?

—I was just trying to defend another one of our villages from falling into The Horde's clutches— Glimmer argues. —She stationed me all the way out there because it's too remote to ever get attacked, but then it did, and it was my *one* chance to prove that I can do this!— she explains. —But she acts like I can't do anything because I'm just a princess!— she then grumbles, annoyed.

—That doesn't make any sense. Everyone here is a princess. I'm, like, the only one who's *not* a princess— Bow points out.

—Tell that to my mom— she groans, dropping herself on the bed.

—Hey, where does this go?— Bow asks, as he busies himself tidying up the room.

—Bottom drawer— she replies, without even needing to look back.

—Anyway, your mom might have a point— he decides to speak. —Only reason you got out of there is because of your teleportation powers, and, let's face it, they don't always work that well— he points out.

—Looking for *support* here, Bow!

—I'm just saying, if you wanna prove yourself, it's gonna take more than running recklessly into any old battle— he explains himself. —Luckily, I've got just the thing. Check this out— he cheerfully tells her, showing Glimmer something on his trackpad. —I detected a piece of First Ones tech in the Whispering Woods. A pretty powerful one, too, by the size of these readings. If you find this one and bring it back, your mom is *bound* to be impressed— he proposes.

—Did you forget I'm grounded?— she reminds him, right before hearing someone knocking on the door.

—Glimmer? Are you in there?— Angella's voice asks, as if on cue.

—Uh…— Glimmer hesitates, teleporting Bow back to the forest in panic.

—Ah!

—Glimmer?— the Queen insists.

—Everything's fine, Mom.

—Is someone else in there? I heard voices— she points out.

—No one else is in here. Can you please just leave me alone?— Glimmer pleads, opening the door.

—I don't appreciate your tone right now, young lady— Angella promptly scolds her, arms folded.

—What tone?

—That attitude of yours is never gonna help, you know?

—Mom, you always tell me what to do…

—You cannot act that way!— Angella interrupts.

—…And that's not fair!— Glimmer still concluded. From outside in the forest, Bow hears the whole discussion, then the door slams, and finally, Glimmer appears next to him. —I'm in.

Meanwhile, back in the Fright Zone, Catra sleeps at the foot of Adora's bunk in the Horde barracks.

Adora tosses and turns, grunting, hearing that unknown female voice call her name.

Gasping, she jolts up and looks around. She smiles at Catra sleeping, then gently eases herself out of bed.

However, Catra opens one eye as she walks away, following her with her gaze.

If she thought she could leave without her noticing…

As Adora exits the room, Catra appears, asking —Hey, where are you going?

—Back to the woods. There's something I need to figure out— she admits, having been caught.

—What? You're not…— she begins, until Adora covers her mouth when a robot passes. They hear it beep as it leaves and Catra finally asks, quite annoyed, —What is wrong with you? You've been acting weird since we got back. Are you *sure* you're not brain-damaged?

—Look, Catra, I *know* I saw something out there— Adora insists. —It's ju- I just need to get another look. It feels important somehow.

Resigned, the magicat accepts —Sounds good. Let's go.

—No. I don't want you getting in trouble on my behalf— Adora argues, brow creased. —Just cover for me, okay? I'll be back before anyone knows I'm gone.

—Adora! Adora!— Catra calls, wanting to stop her.

She knows this won't end well, but can't bring herself to follow…

A while later, in the Whispering Woods, Bow frustratedly fumbles with his trackpad.

—Come on! Come on!

—Uh! Please tell me we're not lost!

—No, this thing is just acting up. Looks like it's being overloaded by the tech's signal— he explains. —We must be getting close!

—Uhh… I think it's that way— Glimmer then points out, stopping in her tracks.

—What makes you say that?— he inquires, finally looking up from his trackpad. As she silently points at a bright light coming from a clearing behind some bushes, he admits —Oh, yeah. That'll do it.

At the same time, somewhere else in the forest, Adora walks in, following her instincts.

And talking to herself…

—What are you doing out here, Adora? Catra's right, this is crazy. There's no sword, you just got hit on the head a little too hard. You should just go back home and forget about all of this before Shadow Weaver has a heart attack.

She almost convinces herself it is all in her mind, but then she spots the glowing light and approaches it.

Moments later, Adora separates dense bushes and sees the luminescent sword she remembered, still trapped by vines in the middle of the clearing.

At the same time, Princess Glimmer and her friend appear, arguing.

—Bow, just let me lead the way, okay?

—The light came from the edge of the forest.

—Yes, you saw the light. It's this way.

—The trackpad says otherwise— he argues.

—It's this way…— she insists, but trails off upon noticing Adora. Bow and Glimmer both gasps, recognizing Adora’s badge, and she gasps too. —Horde soldier!

—I see her!— he replies.

And then both start yelling madly at her, to the detriment of taking any action.

On the contrary, expertly-trained Adora only grunts and runs towards the sword. At that same moment, Glimmer vanishes and reappears next to it, grabbing the sword before Adora can.

—Bow, catch!— the Princess exclaims, tossing it to him.

—Give me the sword— Adora demands, before they both start yelling. Glimmer jumps on her back, but Adora flings her off and spins her weapon. —Get off. Stand down. I *don't* wanna hurt you.

—Since *when* do Horde soldiers not want to hurt anyone?— the Princess scoffs, incredulous.

And before she can reply, Glimmer explodes a glitter bomb in Adora's face and reaches for the sword. Then Adora leaps on top of her, Bow jumps on top of them both, and they all fight on the ground.

Eventually, Adora reaches out and manages to touch the sword.

A light emanates from the weapon, making them all shout, but Adora doesn't hear them anymore.

—What?— she wonders aloud, finding herself in a strange space.

As something like sparkles appear, a female voice greets her —Hello, Adora.

A holographic woman materializes in front of her out of the "sparkles" and she immediately questions her.

—Who are you? What's going on?

The voice, now a woman, replies —My name is Light Hope. I have been waiting a long time for you, but I could not reach you until you forged your connection with the sword.

—You sent the sword?

—The sword is meant for you. Etheria has need of you, Adora. Will you answer its call? Will you fight for the honor of Grayskull?

—What are you talking about? What-what is- What's *Grayskull*? You're not making any sense! I don't understand!— the girl complains, starting to panic.

—You will.

—Wait!— Adora exclaims, as she feels herself being blown backwards while Light Hope vanishes.

Groaning, Adora finally opens her eyes and finds her wrists are bound.

—Hey! She's awake— Bow notices.

—What happened?

—Quiet, Horde spy, *I* ask the questions— Glimmer severely says. —How did you make it this far into the Whispering Woods?

—I just walked in. And I'm not a spy— Adora replies, confused.

—Sure, sure. You *just so happened* to find yourself in the Whispering Woods, like you *just so happened* to try and steal our sword— Glimmer mocks her.

—It's not *yours*. I found it first.

—The Whispering Woods is under the Rebellion's protection. You were lucky to make it as far as you did— the Princess argues. —Come on, Bow. Let's get this spy back to Bright Moon where she can be interrogated properly— she seriously decides. Then, a bit more excited, she turns to him. —This is perfect! Not only do we find First Ones tech for the rebellion, we've also captured a Horde spy! My mom's gonna be so impressed!— she tells him, as if Adora couldn't hear her. Finally, she turns to her prisoner and orders —Now come on, on your feet.

After a long while of walking through the Woods, supposedly aiming to return to Bright Moon, Bow finally decides to ask —You positive we're going the right way, Glimmer?

—I *know* what I'm doing, Bow. Can you please just trust me for once?

—You know I always trust you, but I'm starting to get a *little* freaked out. I mean, I pretty much grew up in these Woods and I've never even seen this part of them. I've heard stories about weird stuff out here— he explains, a bit apologetic at first.

—It's fine, okay? Just let me figure this out— she insists, getting annoyed.

—Okay! *Touchy*— he lets out. —Sorry about her. Usually, she's really nice— Bow then tells Adora, who doesn't reply. —Not much for talking, huh?

—I prefer not to swap pleasantries with my captors— she seriously states.

—Fair. Suit yourself— he accepts, without opposing much resistance.

Then, as Glimmer teleports away, Adora turns to him and asks —You know she's a princess, right? How can you *follow her*? Princesses are a dangerous threat to everyone on Etheria.

—Is that what Hordak told you?— he asks back, raising a brow, slightly amused.

—Well, I thought it was just common knowledge— Adora argues. —They're violent instigators who don't even know how to control their powers— she explains, serious.

As if on cue, Glimmer appears over a huge tree root and shouts madly.

After looking at her for a second, Bow asks —You've never actually met a princess, have you?

—Well, maybe not in person, but…— Adora tries to excuse herself, until they hear Glimmer whimper.

Exchanging a concerned glance, they both run to her and find the Princess standing before the ruins of a forest dwelling.

As Glimmer bends down to pick up a cracked drawing of a young child holding the hand of an adult, Adora takes a step forward and asks —What happened to this place?

—Don't play dumb with me. I bet you were part of the raiding party that did this— Glimmer immediately snaps.

—What are you talking about? The Horde didn't do this— Adora reacts, indignant.

—Oh, yeah?— Glimmer scoffs, and drags Adora to a Horde robot crashed on the ground. —You're a heartless destroyer, just like all the rest of your people— she accuses her.

—I'm not a destroyer— she promptly replies. —Hordak says we're doing what's best for Etheria. We're trying to make things better. More orderly— Adora insists.

—*This* is what's best for Etheria!?— Glimmer exclaims. —Ever since The Horde got here, they've been poisoning our land, burning our cities, destroying everything in their path— she enumerated. —And you're a part of it! How's *that* for orderly?— the Princess further accuses her.

Striding ahead angrily, Glimmer leaves Adora alone, thinking.

—This doesn't make any sense. The Horde would *never* do something like this— she says, thinking aloud, unable to believe what she's seeing.

—Did you really not know any of this? I mean, your army is called the "Evil Horde"— Bow points out, approaching her.

—Who calls us that?— she indignantly asks, much to his dismay.

—…*Everybody*!

But Adora still can't believe it.

Refuses to believe it.

—The Horde rescued me when I was a baby and gave me a home. They're my family. You-you don't know them like I do— she argues.

—Maybe *you* don't know them like you think you do.

Before Adora could further argue, Glimmer runs back, shouting —There's something out there! Something big!

—How big?— Bow inquires, right before the ground rumbles, making them grunt. Then, a giant insect-like creature pops out of the earth. —So, pretty big then— he utters, shocked but still preparing an arrow. As it extends its six clawed legs, he warns —Watch out!

Without thinking, Glimmer leaps onto the bug's head but it tosses her backwards without much effort, so Adora sees a chance to escape, but her foot gets stuck in a crack in the ground.

And then the beast turns to her.

She tugs on her trapped foot, more panicked now, while Bow shoots an arrow and a web covers the creature's mouth.

Grunting and yelling, Glimmer throws a series of glitter bombs at the creature, but it screeches and whacks her into a tree.

She slumps on the ground and Bow aims another arrow, ready to keep firing.

And right as Adora frees her foot, the beast flings Bow into a tree trunk.

On instinct, she looks at the sword.

She finally has it.

However, instead of escaping, she notices as Glimmer kneels and weakly shoots glitter bombs as the beast draws near.

The sword crackles with electricity in Adora's hand and she realizes *she has a choice*.

—Hey, bug brain!— she calls, drawing the monster’s attention. Great. She *made* a choice. She’d prove she’s not a destroyer. But now, *what*? —Come on, Magic Sword. Oh, where's a blinding flash of light when you need one?— she pleads, panicking again.

As the beast charges toward her, she fumbles the sword. It takes her a second, but she finally manages to pick it up and lifts it above her head.

A flashing beam of light radiates from the blade and Adora sees it all again while hearing the voice of Light Hope calling and the baby crying.

—Will you fight for the honor of Grayskull?— Light Hope’s voice sounds in her head. —… Honor of Grayskull?— it echoes.

And so she understands.

Sword risen, Adora cries out —For the honor of Grayskull!

Glimmer and Bow shield their eyes as bright light glows around them.

And immediately after, the beast kneels.

Adora has transformed into a warrior princess with flowing long hair and a cape.

She-Ra has appeared.

Chapter End Notes

Part 2 is already available, ofc

Thanks for reading this first half! I hope you continue! :D

The Sword - Part 2

Chapter Notes

Short note so I don't take much of your time.
… Ok, no, I was gonna say a fun fact, but let's instead go with something important:
Remember the very much canon moment of Catra being zapped and paralized? It's still there. "How?" you may wonder, if SW's overprotective?
The answer is: she's quite out of her mind, you'll soon see...

Just warning in case you weren't expecting it...
Actually, I added the "canon typical violence" tag now just for this <("^_^)

Anyways! I hope you enjoy!!

Glimmer and Bow shield their eyes as bright light glows around them.

And immediately after, the beast kneels.

Adora has transformed into a warrior princess with flowing long hair and a cape.

She-Ra has appeared.

Watching in awe, Bow calls —Glimmer?

—Yeah, I see her, Bow.

—Okay. I wanted to make sure it wasn't just me.

Finally seeing the sword in her hands, Adora screams.

She suddenly morphs back into Adora and, panting, she lets out —Huh?

That snaps Glimmer back into reality and she teleports next to her, grabbing the sword from her hands.

Both grunt, tugging the sword back and forth between them.

—Stay where you are!— Glimmer warns her, still trying to snatch it.

—What did you do to me!?

—What do you *mean* what did I do to you?— she asks back.

—I didn't know being a princess was contagious!— Adora panics, disgusted, but never lets go of the sword.

—Okay, okay, everyone, calm down!— Bow pleads. Trying to keep things civil, despite the girls being engaged in some weird tug-o-war, he asks Adora —Wanna tell us how you did that?

—I didn't do anything— she insists. —All I did was pick up the sword, and then, *whoosh*, I'm in a tiara!— she explains, indignant.

—I don't care how she did it. We just have to make sure she never does it again!— Glimmer angrily decides, finally snatching the sword from Adora's hands and walking away from her.

Wrong move.

As if feeling that, the creature rises and stabs the ground with its front legs before letting out a loud roar that made them all yell.

Adora falls and Bow and Glimmer hide inside a tree, only to have the monster go after them.

As it lets out another roar, hitting the trunk of the tree, Bow swiftly takes the sword and runs to Adora, desperately begging —Do it again! Do it again!

—Bow!— Glimmer complains.

—Do what you did before!

—I don't know what I did before!— Adora argues, between apologetic and panicked.

—No time! We have to go!— Glimmer remarks, leaving her precarious hiding spot and prompting them to run through the forest while the bug-creature chases them.

Soon, they reach the edge of a cliff and fall over the side, then land below in a heap.

The sword slips from Adora's hands and that's when she notices symbols on the ground that lead to a triangular structure.

—What is this place?— she asks, curious and momentarily forgetting about the monster.

However, as the beast looms above, Bow considers —No idea, but in there's gotta be better than out here.

Right then, the creature falls down like they did before, and while it's stunned the three run towards the entrance, which Bow tries to open, to no avail.

—Everyone, grab on, I can get us in there!— Glimmer decides, seeing how it was impossible to open.

—Glimmer, no! You've never teleported three people before— Bow points out, concerned.

—Do you have a better idea?— she argues.

But they have no more time.

The creature gets up and approaches.

However, Adora notices —What's written on this door? It looks like some kind of password.

—You can read that?— Bow reacts.

—You *can't*!?— she asks back.

—What's it say!?— he urges her.

—Uh, "Eternia".

On command, the triangular door glows and opens.

—Oh, come on!— Glimmer complains, as they hurry inside, and the door closes on the beast.

In the middle of the darkness, a bright pink orb appears and faintly illuminates the hallway in front of Princess Glimmer.

—So, Horde soldier, have you always been able to read First Ones' writing?— Bow decides to ask Adora.

—Wanna tell us what exactly is going on here?— Glimmer accusingly demands, before the girl can answer, slightly blinding her with her light.

—I told you I don't know! I just read the word on the door.

—Right— Glimmer scoffs, and chuckles bitterly. —You read a word in a language that no one's spoken for a thousand years, and the door just opened into a mysterious ancient ruin. *Sure*.

—You think I did this *on purpose*? You think I *wanted* to be a princess? Princesses are *monsters*.

—*Monsters*? You're the monster!— Glimmer indignantly rebukes.

—Whoa, whoa, whoa, whoa— Bow intercedes. —Glimmer, she *did* save us.

—I don't care! We *can't* just trust her, Bow!— the Princess insists. —Or have you forgotten everything the Horde's done to us? The people we've *lost*!?— she remarks, sobbing for a second before she catches herself. As soon as she composes herself, Glimmer seriously sentences —We need to find another way out of here and get her back to Bright Moon as soon as possible. My mother will know what to do with her.

As Glimmer continues forward, getting way ahead, Bow decides to gently thank Adora.

—Hey, so, thanks for saving us from that bug thing back there when you could've escaped instead.

—Okay, well, I didn't save you. I just wanted to get the sword, okay?— she argues, feeling a bit exposed all of a sudden.

—Are you *sure* it's not because you secretly like us?— he jokes, making her chuckle.

—Wha-? I don't like you— she quickly denies. —You're my captors— she reiterates, as if reminding it to herself.

—Sure— he coyly smiles. Then they start walking, and eventually, he insists —Thanks for saving us anyway. I'm Bow, by the way.

—Adora— she briskly replies.

—"Adora." Ah. Weird name for a Horde soldier— he considers.

—Is it?— she quickly asks, confused.

Meanwhile, Glimmer has stopped walking, waiting for them, and looks at the sword for a moment before whispering —For the honor of Grayskull.

—What are we doing?— Bow suddenly asks, startling her.

—Nothing!— she exclaims, caught red-handed. —I mean, uhh… Look at these carvings— she deflects. —I think this might be a First Ones' ruin.

—What's a First One?— Adora finally asks, realizing it’s the second time they mention that.

—You've never heard of the First Ones?— Glimmer asks back, incredulous.

—The First Ones are the original settlers of Etheria— Bow begins explaining. —They disappeared a thousand years ago, but they left behind a lot of old ruins and technology. Like this place— he elaborated.

—So, what happened to them?

—No one knows. They just disappeared— he shrugs. —The Horde didn't tell you about them?— he then asks, curious himself.

—Seems like there's a lot the Horde didn't tell me— Adora mutters, starting to feel… hesitant.

Eventually, they reach a hall and stop for a moment.

—Ugh. How do we get out of here?— Glimmer groans, frustrated.

—It'll take forever to find a way out at this rate— Bow sighs in response. —Hey! Wanna turn on some lights, Adora?— he then jokes.

—I don't know how to do that.

—Maybe there's a magic word— he considers. —Ooh, what's the First Ones' word for "lights"?— he asks, excited.

—I don't know. I'm not magic— she replies, a bit disgusted again.

—Obviously— Glimmer remarks, rolling her eyes. Fed up, she orders —Everyone, stand back.

But before she can do anything, Bow warns her —Uh, Glimmer? Maybe you should take it easy. We're a long way from Bright Moon. It'll be a while until you can recharge.

—Bow!— she immediately complains, indignant.

—You have to recharge your powers?— Adora incredulously asks.

—Can we *not* talk about this in front of the Horde soldier?— she reproaches him. —Now, stand back— she orders again.

Reluctantly, Bow stands beside Adora, Glimmer squeezes her eyes shut and tosses the shiny ball of light into the air, expanding its light all over the place.

—Woah— Adora gasps, marvelled.

Right after, Glimmer groans and Bow rushes to catch her. —Wow. Are you okay?

—I'm fine, Bow.

And then they notice there is an image of a warrior princess holding a sword on the wall.

—Oh hey! That's you!— Bow tells Adora.

—What? That doesn't look anything like me— she argues.

—No, I mean, the other you. The scary one in the cape— he clarifies.

—That was me?— she asks, now allured by the realization that she looked like that.

As she studies the image, he asks —You can read that inscription, right? What's it say?

—It says… "She-Ra".

Seemingly activated by her voice, the image lights up and her eyes widen as the light radiates around the room.

A hologram appears in front of them and makes them all shout.

—Greetings, administrator— it speaks.

—What is this thing?— Adora asks, confused.

—What is your query?— it then asks.

—I think it's some kind of ancient hologram— Bow points out, intrigued.

—What is your query?— it repeats.

—Uh… Hi. What is this place? How do we get out of here?— he asks, unsure.

—What is your query?

—Welp. She's broken— he determines, resigned.

—She's old. I'm surprised any of this stuff still works at all— Glimmer scoffs.

In complete disbelief, she runs her hand through the hologram, not expecting any reaction, but it turns red.

—Administrator not detected. Lockdown initiated— it speaks, much to their horror.

All around the hall, a series of doors slam shut around them and the rock structure begins to crumble.

Glimmer turns to the hologram and frantically says —I didn't do it!

—No. No. No lockdown! No lockdown!— Bow joins in, trying to communicate with the hologram. However, the lockdown continues, the ceiling shatters, and he panics. —Adora, you gotta get it to stop!

—What makes you think I can?

—Query not recognized— it speaks again, as if reacting to her voice.

—There's gotta be a password or something!— he insist.

—Uh, stop it! Uh, Eternia! Eternia!— she desperately yells, to no avail. Then it occurs to her —Give me the sword!

—What? *No*!— Glimmer cries out.

—We need the scary lady in the cape— she argues. —I don't know how, but she's the key to this place, so maybe she can get us out.

—You're a Horde soldier. I'm not giving you the sword— the Princess insists.

As pieces of ceiling start to fall, Adora resignedly shouts more words.

—Eternia! Uh, cape! Uh… She-Ra!

But nothing works.

And so, out of options, Glimmer rushes to link arms with both Bow and Adora.

—Hold on!— she yells.

—Glimmer, no!

But she does.

She teleports them out right before a huge piece of ceiling falls on their heads.

They appear high in the sky.

—Glimmer!— Bow yells, as the three freefall into the Woods. With Glimmer unconscious, he had to think fast, and so he shoots an arrow that produces a web, catching them three right in time. —Glimmer? Glimmer!— he keeps calling.

—Did it work?— she groans in response, finally waking up.

—Yeah, it worked— he chuckles. Then, more seriously, he adds —Barely. Are you alright?

—I'm fine— she groans again. —I think I used too much power getting us out of there.

—I don't know who could've predicted that… Oh, right. Me— he proudly reminds her.

—Bow…

—Like an hour ago— he adds.

—Bow!— she insists.

—Sorry. I'm just glad you're okay— he apologetically admits, worried. —No more teleporting for a while, okay? You could really hurt yourself.

—I'm fine, okay? Let's just get back to Bright Moon so I can recharge already— she sighs, feeling defeated. And then… she notices Adora. —Why are you still here?

—What?

—Bow and I are hardly a crack security team. You could've escaped at any time— she elaborates. —Why didn't you?

—I just- I wanna figure out what's happening to me, and if I go back to the Fright Zone, then I'll never know— she admits. —I never knew where I came from or who my family was. Shadow Weaver said it didn't matter who I was before, that-that I was nothing before Hordak took me in— she explains. —There's always been a part of me that I don't know anything about an-and all of this, it feels familiar somehow. I don't know how else to explain it— Adora expresses.

Glimmer hesitates for a second, looks at the badge on the girl's jacket and scowls, but Bow puts his hand on her shoulder.

—Glimmer's mom knows more about First Ones' tech than anyone— he decides to say. —She'll know what's going on with you and the sword for sure— he assures her. —So, if you want your questions answered, stick with us?— he proposes, extending his hand towards her.

However, Glimmer doesn't extend the same trust to her and only stars walking as she orders —Let's go. There should be a village a few miles from here. They'll be able to give us a ride back to Bight Moon. We've wasted too much time already.

Back in the Fright Zone, Catra is being interrogated by Shadow Weaver within the Black Garnet's chamber.

—For the last time, where is Adora?— the dark sorceress severely asks.

—For the last time, I don't know. You think I keep her on a leash?— Catra retorts, keeping her nervousness controlled.

But not enough for this woman.

—I *know* you're lying. You two are *close*. She would *never* depart without telling you— she points out.

—Then I guess she let us both down, huh?— the magicat sighs, looking away.

—Are you not *worried* about her? Do you not want her *back*!?— Shadow Weaver tries to convince her, but Catra remains silent. —Have it your way. I already know where she is. We've been tracking her— she finally reveals.

—Uh, then why did you ask me?

—Because you are going to bring her back— she severely sentences.

—I don't think so— Catra grunts, aiming to leave.

However, she immediately gets zapped by red electricity that paralyzes her, and the dark sorceress indignantly cries out —Do you *think* I want to send you out there, insolent child!? This is an order from above!

—Then *refuse* it— the magicat defies her. —But you don't care about me or Adora. You don't care about any of us!

—You know *nothing*!— Shadow Weaver sneers. —Lord Hordak issued an order, and I have to see it carried out! I never wanted Adora to be sent out in the first place, and now she's gone without formal orders or support!— she begins, voice growing louder and threatening as she paces in front of the paralyzed magicat. —You have no choice but to go for her. *I* have

no choice but to send you! I am not losing any of you, and that includes Adora!— she goes on, voice breaking. —So you will do as I ask, *exactly* as I say, and no one will get hurt.

Meanwhile, in the forest village to which Adora and her "captors" arrived, the inhabitants dance and frolic, chatter and laugh.

—Okay, the jacket comes off— the Princess orders.

—What? Why?

—If the villagers see a Horde soldier, they'll freak out. We gotta fix… all *this*— she explains, urging Adora to comply.

Once she takes off her jacket, Glimmer offers her cape as a sash, to cover the horde symbol on Adora's back.

—I feel ridiculous.

—That's 'cause you need something to tie it all together— Bow assures her, before putting a flower in her hair.

But it only makes her feel *worse*.

—I don't like it— she insists.

—Point is, you don't look like a Horde soldier— Glimmer remarks. —Just keep a low profile. We'll be in and out— she assures her.

With that fixed, they properly enter the village.

—What is this?— Adora asks, curious but mostly confused.

—It's a festival. Like a big party— Bow replies, earning an even more confused look from her. —You don't have parties in the Fright Zone?

—Oh, right, parties— she utters, awkwardly pretending she understands. —I mean, yeah, pfft, of course. I, uh- I don't know what that is— she finally admits.

—Ah!— he whimpers.

—Did you even hear me? I said, in and out!— Glimmer reminds him, upset.

—She has never been to a party before, Glimmer! This is serious— he insists.

And so he decides to introduce Adora to the concept of a party.

He first leads her to a food stand, hands her a piece of food, and as she takes a bite her eyes light up.

Meanwhile, a villager tries to put a wreath on Glimmer's head and she swats him away.

Later, musicians play as they sit at a table, all while Adora stuffs food in her mouth, ravenous. Seeing her so… fascinated by the food, Glimmer shoves a plate of food over, and Adora devours it.

Soon after, they pass young children playing a piñata-like game, and a youth hands Adora a stick of wood.

She knows what to do.

Without hesitation, she approaches the dangling toy, wearing a fierce expression, whacks it, and cracks it open, allowing the kids to run forward to collect the innards while she stands proudly hearing them cheer.

And a bit later, a villager performs with his hands in front of a crowd of youths. Adora watches wide-eyed behind a tree while Glimmer stands beside her.

—So, seriously? No parties ever? What do you guys do on your birthday?

—Huh?

—No birthdays!? How is your life this sad?— Bow questions her, sorrowful.

But something else catches Adora’s attention.

With a gasp, she asks —What is *that*?

—That would be a horse— Bow replies, noticing she was pointing at one grazing in a meadow.

As it neighs, she sighs —It's majestic.

—You wanna go meet it?— he offers, smiling brightly.

—What? No!— she whines, hardly resisting as he takes her to it.

—Come on, it's okay— he assures her. He extends her hand towards it and she shyly pats the horse’s snout. —See, he likes you.

Gasping, she lets out —This is the best day of my life.

—Bow— Glimmer calls.

Oblivious to the reason, he replies —Come on, I know you like her, too.

Until the Princess makes him notice the smoke that billows from the village, and they hear rumbling and people screaming nearby.

—What's going on?— Adora asks, hearing the noise too.

They run back, and Adora gapes as fires blaze from the village dwellings.

Horde tanks overrun the village.

—It's the Horde!— the Princess exclaims, before the three hide in a hut.

—Why are they here? The people of Thaymor aren't a threat— Bow wonders, making Adora immediately understand.

Or not.

She actually has more questions now.

—Wait. Did you say *Thaymor*? This can't be Thaymor— she expresses, in utter disbelief.

—Did you know something about this?

—No. I mean, yes— she stammers. —But there's a mistake. Thaymor's supposed to be a heavily fortified rebel fortress, not a civilian town!— Adora manages to explain.

—Do you really think that matters to them?— Glimmer scoffs, gesturing at the tanks.

—I can get them to stop— she assures them. —This is all a big mistake. I just need to talk to them— she insists. —Get as many people out as you can and don't let them see you— she asks them, removing the sash to reveal the Horde symbol on her back. —I'm sorry.

—Adora!— Glimmer yells, but she hurries off, sprinting past the villagers as they scatter in fright.

She stops, stunned as a Horde tank barges through a hut nearby and gets in front of it.

—Stop!

It does come to a halt… only to reveal Catra is inside.

—Adora!

—Catra?

—They let me drive a tank. Believe it?— she excitedly laughs.

—Catra, I don't understand. What are you doing here?— Adora asks, confused.

—Uh, *duh*, we came to find you— she replies, rolling her eyes. —"Cover for me, Catra. No one will even know I'm gone". Seriously, did you just get *immediately* captured right after you snuck out?— she mocks her, until she notices the flower. —What are you wearing?

—Uh…— the girl hesitates, before ripping the flower from her hair.

Meanwhile, the villagers flee.

One trips and Glimmer helps her up.

A Horde robot arrives right after, and an arrow pierces the front window.

Then Glimmer turns as a Horde soldier comes up behind Bow.

—Bow!— she shouts, before teleporting to whack the soldier.

—Hey!

—There's no time. We have to put a stop to this— Adora pleads, grabbing Catra's hands.

—What? Why?

—Because this is a civilian town. Look around! These aren't insurgents. They're innocent people!— she argues.

—Yeah, *sure*. Innocent people who kidnapped a Horde officer— Catra counters. —Now, come on, let's get you back to the Fright Zone. Shadow Weaver is freaking out— she laughs, pulling from her. —No, seriously. She's speaking about not losing you or whatever. She's two steps away from a real heart-attack, or a meltdown, and I don't wanna deal with that.

—Catra, no. I can't go back. Not until the Horde leaves this town alone— Adora refuses. Holding her hands tighter, she tells her —You have to help me.

—What are you saying?

—I'm saying this is *wrong*. They've been lying to us, manipulating us. Hordak, Shadow Weaver, *all of them*— Adora clarifies, as if it weren't evident.

—Duh!— Catra mockingly scoffs. —Did ya just figure that out? Manipulation is Shadow Weaver's whole thing! She's been messing with our heads since we were kids— Catra points out.

—How could you *possibly* be okay with that?

—*You* were the one saying she was only "looking out for us"! Adora, this has never been right, but I endured it because it doesn't matter what they do. The two of us look out for each other. And soon we'll be calling the shots— Catra reminded her. —Now, can we go home already?

—I'm not going home, Catra. I can't. Not after everything I've seen— she denies. Pulling from the magicat's hands to bring her closer, she requests —Come with me. You don't have to go back there. We can *fix this*.

But Catra immediately pulls away, disgusted.

—Are you kidding? You've known these people for, *what*? A couple of hours? And now you're just gonna throw everything away for *them*?— she scoffs, indignant. —Ugh. What *happened* to you?

—I don't know. But I have to do something. I'm sorry, Catra— the girl sighs, turning to leave.

However, before she can so much as take a step, the magicat produces an electric baton and zaps her.

Meanwhile, Glimmer and Bow direct the villagers.

—Ah! I think that's all of them. Glimmer, let's go!— he calls. But they are suddenly surrounded by Horde soldiers who start blasting at them with their weapons, forcing them to hide in a cave. —What are we gonna do?

—There's nothing we can do, Bow. You're almost out of arrows and I'm almost out of magic — Glimmer replies, sorrowful.

—You can't say that. You're Glimmer! You throw yourself into every fight, no matter how hopeless— he encourages her, unable to see her so dispirited.

—Ugh. Every decision I've made in the last day has almost gotten us killed— she retorts, shaking her head. —My mom's right, I'm not ready for this yet…

—No. You are not giving up right now— Bow disagrees. —I'm sorry your mom doesn't see how strong you are, but that's her loss. You can do this, Glimmer, and you don't have to do it alone.

—You're right. We need Adora— the Princess nods, earning a confused look from him.

—We do? Didn't she just sell us out to the Horde?

—I don't think she did— she denies. —We need to find her. I think she can help us— she decides. —Just trust me. Okay?

Glimmer gives him a pleading look and it's enough to convince him.

He smiles in agreement and they both hop on the horse, who neighs before trotting off.

Meanwhile, Catra stands over Adora, electric baton still in hand.

—Oh, man. That was a lot stronger than I thought. Are you okay?— she apologetically asks.

—Catra!

—I'm sorry! It was a reflex— she admits, sheepish.

—Why are you doing this?— Adora sobs, looking back at her from the ground.

—Because you left me! And if I don't bring you back, Shadow Weaver's gonna have my head — she explains, indignant. —I don't care what you think or what she says about "protecting" us. I'm sure that's all bullshit! So, enough with your weird little identity crisis and let's go home already— she adds, incredulous. —Or do I need to zap you again?— she then threatens, as doubt settles in her mind.

However, as soon as she points her baton at Adora again, a sparkle bomb startles her and Catra shrieks.

—Glimmer?— Adora asks, seeing her and Bow arrive on horseback.

He immediately traps Catra on a web while Glimmer helps Adora up, yet it's far from enough.

—Watch out!— the Princess cries out, before teleporting her away.

—Adora!— Catra calls in turn, knocking Bow off the horse instead.

As the girls reappear in a nearby clearing, Glimmer weakens in Adora's arms.

—Glimmer? What are you doing? Why did you save me?

—We need you. We need She-Ra— she explains, unhanging the sword from her back and offering it to Adora. —I should've given this back to you in the ruin. You could've saved us in there and I knew that. But I was stupid. And a jerk— Glimmer admits. —And I almost got us killed and I'm sorry!

—You're not any of those things— Adora denies. She then points out —I'm the Horde soldier. How do you know you can trust me now?

—I don't. But I hope I can— the Princess confesses. —I feel like maybe you're here to help us.

Right as Glimmer holds out the sword for her, a Horde robot appears as if on cue, and Adora takes it to face the robot now racing forward.

—For the honor of Grayskull!

Immediately, a light shines as Adora transforms into the warrior princess, She-Ra. Her body is covered with a gold and white uniform, her blonde hair flows out behind her and a crown forms on her head.

She-Ra tosses the sword in the air and punches her open palm, producing a pair of golden wristbands. The sword lands in her hand and she holds it overhead.

Soon after, she slices the robot in half, then glances back at Glimmer.

Meanwhile, Bow and Catra are still fighting.

He flings her off and runs to the horse, but Horde robots and tanks surround him.

—It's been an honor serving beside you, Horsey— he tells the horse, seeing no escape.

Catra smiles smugly as they close in.

However, a bright light suddenly shines and the Horde soldiers shield their eyes as She-Ra strides forward, glowing light surrounding her.

She stops and pierces the ground with her sword, it crumbles under their feet and electricity crackles from the rocks.

Bow blinks his eyes as She-Ra stands before him, expression neutral.

She pulls her sword from the ground as a tank aims its gun at her, she leaps up and slices the weapon from the armed vehicle, making it explode.

Catra observes wearing a grim expression, realizing what’s going on.

Another soldier races forward, and She-Ra stops them with her sword. Then a robot attacks and She-Ra grasps its legs and flings it away.

Taking advantage of the distraction, Glimmer goes to her friend.

—Bow! Are you okay?

—Is that Adora?— he asks back, in shock.

—It's She-Ra— she replies with a hopeful smile.

—Retreat!— a Horde soldier screams, seconded by their comrades, all screaming.

As the Horde retreats, the light flickers and She-Ra morphs back into Adora.

She collapses on her knees, panting, the sword in her right hand, standing vertically in front of her.

As the smoke clears, the magicat faces Adora.

—Catra…— she calls, but she backs away and disappears.

Before Adora can so much as think about chasing after her, Bow leaps on her.

—You did it!

—I did?— she asks, incredulous.

—You saved us. You saved everyone!— Glimmer confirms, both hugging Adora.

—I did it— she first chuckles. —I turned against the Horde— she then realizes, expression darkening for a moment. And right after, she panics —I turned against the Horde! Why did I do that? I can't go back now. Where am I supposed to go?

—Hey, hey. It's okay. You're with us now— Glimmer supportingly tells her. —C’mon, let's go home.

Smiling, Adora takes Glimmer’s hand and stands up.

They walk off with their arms around each other and Bow grins sheepishly.

—Best friends squad!— he tells them, excited. Then, he notices the horse follows them, and lets out —Wait, whose horse was this?

End Notes

Alright! That was all!
I don't think I'll rewrite more episodes, even if it's tempting, because the more we move forwards from here, the more probable it is that the butterfly effect triggers wild differences I can't deal with imho…

So, uh, I hope you enjoyed this little thing, and in any case, thanks Solaris for this freaking awesome idea XD

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!